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The Future Of Search

We search all the time. Search engines, not portals, are the order of the day. Where is search headed? When will the perfect search engine arrive?

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Second only perhaps to e-mail, search engines are probably the most useful thing on the Internet—where would you go without them? How many URLs do you know about that you just happened to stumble upon, following links? Most of your bookmarks are probably the result of Googling, or of having used some other search engine.

But is Google God? Not yet, at least. And no other search engine is, either.

How many times have you wished that Google's 'I'm feeling lucky' button would take you to the exact page you were looking for? And how many times has that actually happened? Even if you think it did, there was probably a page out there that was better than

what Google showed up when you pressed 'I'm feeling lucky'.

The idea is that a search engine needs to fetch the few specific pages from the billions available that interest you. It's a daunting task.

The problem gets broken into three parts. The first is the keywords you enter: how accurate are they? The second is in the way the search engines map the Net. And finally, there's the problem of people accurately tagging their Web pages so the search engine knows what a particular page is about.

We now have desktop search, video and image search, local search, and more, in addition to just the directory-based search of a few years ago. So where is search today, and where do we wish it to take us? Will that 'I'm feeling lucky' button become the magic button you've always wanted?